P-C-437
AMENDMENT—2
March 5, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Amendment—1
July 3, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLEANING COMPOUND, HIGH PRESSURE (STEAM) CLEANER

This amendment, which forms a part of Federal Specification P-C-437, dated October 30, 1961, was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

Page 1, under paragraph 2.1, Federal Specifications, add:

PPP-D-723—Drums, Fiber.
PPP-D-729—Drums: Metal, 55-Gallon (For Shipment of Noncorrosive Material).
PPP-P-704—Pails: Shipping, Steel (1 through 12 Gallon).

Page 2, under paragraph 2.1, Military Specifications, add:

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.

Paragraph 3.2: Add the following subparagraph:

3.2.2 *Ingredient materials.* The ingredient materials used in the manufacture of the steam cleaning compound covered by this specification shall be granular, not powdered. Not more than 3.0 percent of each nonliquid ingredient shall pass a No. 100 mesh U. S. screen when tested as specified in 4.4.12.

Page 3, paragraph 3.12: Delete and substitute the following:

3.12 **Fineness.** The particle size of the cleaning compound shall be such that 100 percent shall pass a No. 6 sieve and not more than 3.0 percent shall pass a No. 100 sieve when tested as specified in 4.4.12.

Page 4, paragraph 4.3.1: After the second sentence insert the following: "Separate two-pound samples of each ingredient shall be submitted for qualification testing for particle size (see 3.2.2)."

Page 8, paragraph 4.4.12: Delete and substitute the following:

4.4.12 *Fineness.* A No. 6 and a No. 100 seive shall be used in a RoTap (or equal) sieve shaking apparatus. The sieves shall be 8-inch diameter U. S. standard wire cloth sieves conforming to ASTM E11. Transfer a 100 ± 0.1 gram sample, without previous drying, to the No. 6 sieve. Allow the shaking apparatus to run 10 minutes. Examine the No. 6 screen for any retained cleaning compound and weigh the portion passing the No. 100 sieve and calculate to percentage. If a sieving machine is not available, use the hand sieving procedure of ASTM method D502 or method 2101 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 536.

Paragraph 5.1 Packaging, levels A and C. Delete and substitute:

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be levels A, B, or C, as specified (6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A or B.* The product shall be packaged in 25-, 125-, and 400-pound quantities. The 25- and 125-pound quantities shall be packaged in drums conforming to PPP-P-704, type II; and PPP-D-705, type III, respectively. The 400-pound quantity shall be packaged in a drum conforming to PPP-D-729, type III. Closures shall be as specified for the drum type in the applicable container specification.

FSC 6850

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The product shall be packaged in 25-, 125-, or 400-pound quantities in fiber drums conforming to PPP-D-723, type I or II, grade A. Drum liners (bags) shall be provided and shall be fabricated from 3-mil thick polyethlene conforming to MIL-P-3803. All bag seams shall be heat sealed. The seals shall meet the heat seal requirements of MIL-P-116. Bag closure may be accomplished by a method other than heat seal when approved by the procuring activity.

Page 9, add the following to paragraph 6:

6.4.1 *Mixing.* It has been found that compound prepared by charging the granular ingredients into the blender followed by a short premix and then admixing the liquid surfactant has less tendency to lump or agglomerate than when produced by other orders of mixing.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—MR

Navy—SH

Air Force—68

Review Activities:

Army—MI, MR, MU

Navy—SH

Air Force—68

Civil Agencies—GSA

Using Activities:

Navy—WP, YD, MC

Preparing Activity:

Army—MR

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use